

Hypocalcaemia in adults

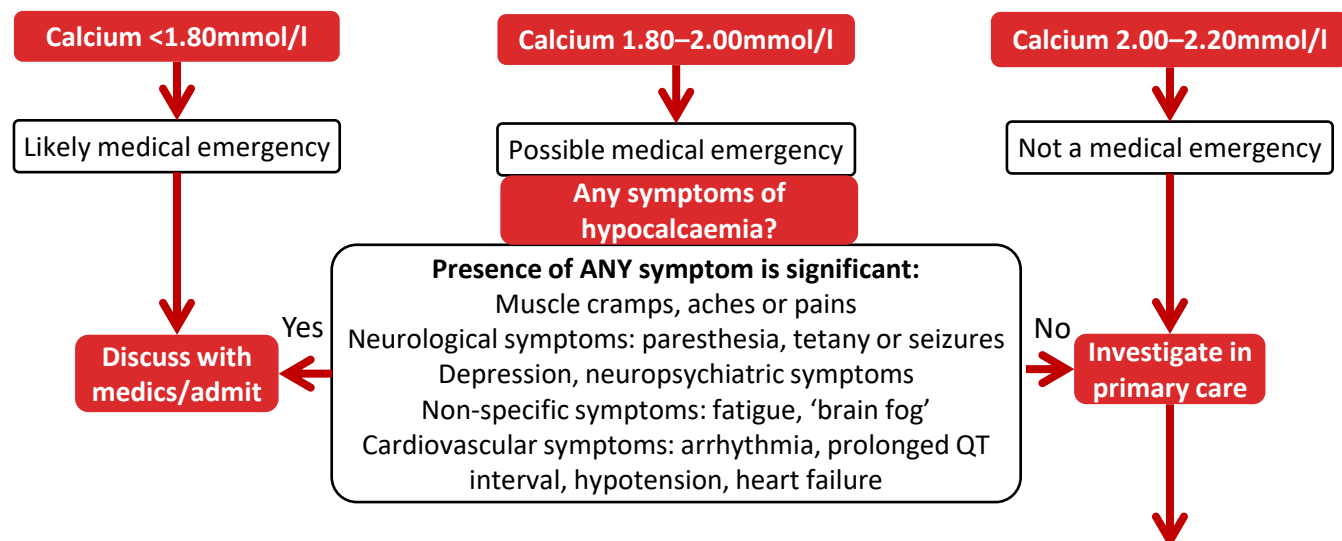
Derbyshire Shared Care Pathology Guidelines, accessed June 2023, NEJM
2019;380:1738



Red Whale

GEMS
Guidelines & Evidence Made Simple

In this GEMS, all 'calcium' values refer to 'corrected calcium' (adjusted for albumin)

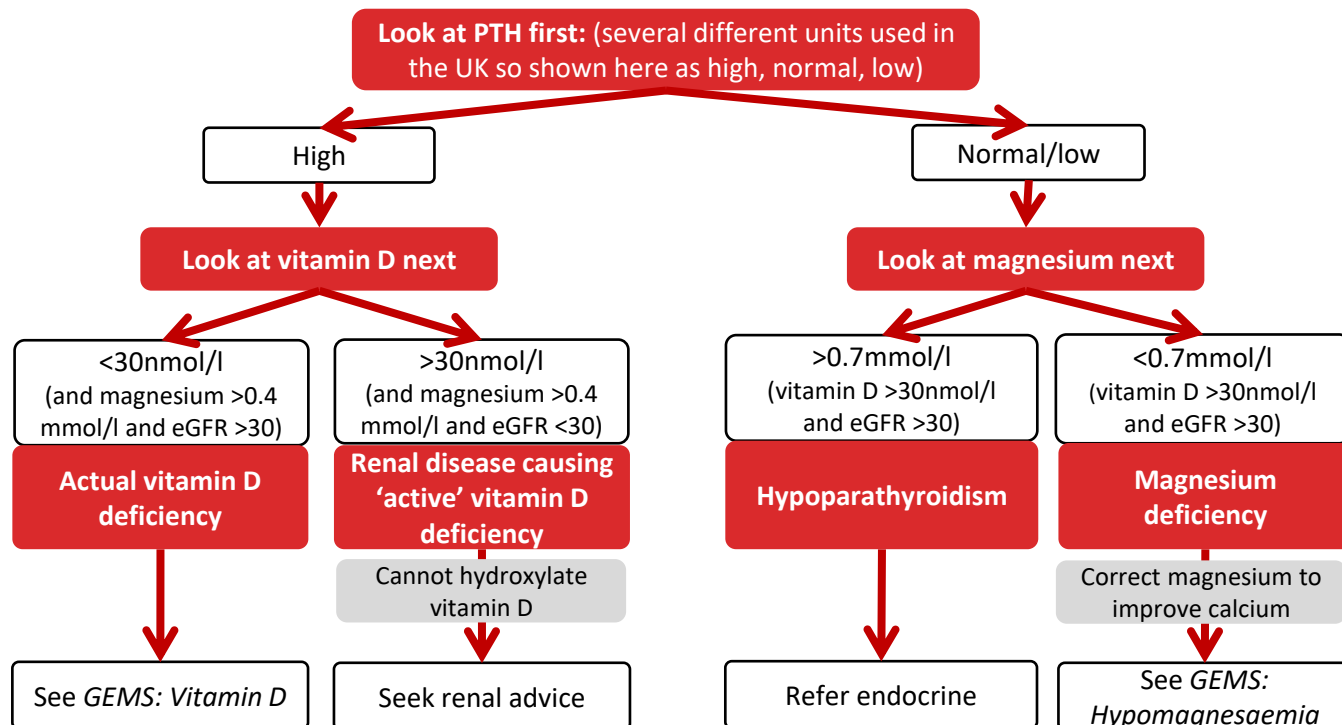


Check U&Es, vitamin D, PTH and magnesium, and look for an underlying cause

There are FOUR main causes of hypocalcaemia:

Actual vitamin D deficiency	Functional vitamin D deficiency	Hypoparathyroidism	Hypomagnesaemia
Lack of sun, dietary, malabsorptive, e.g. coeliac	Renal or liver disease (cannot hydroxylate vitamin D)	After neck surgery (75%), autoimmune, genetic	See <i>Hypomagnesaemia</i> GEMS

Framework for assessing for underlying cause (in a patient well enough to be managed in primary care)



We make every effort to ensure the information in these pages is accurate and correct at the date of publication, but it is of necessity of a brief and general nature. The information presented herein should not replace your own good clinical judgement, or be regarded as a substitute for taking professional advice in appropriate circumstances. In particular, we suggest you carefully consider the specific facts, circumstances and medical history of any patient, and recommendations of the relevant regulatory authorities. We also suggest that you check drug doses, potential side-effects and interactions with the British National Formulary. Save insofar as any such liability cannot be excluded at law, we do not accept any liability for loss of any type caused by reliance on the information in these pages. September 2023. For full references see the relevant Red Whale articles.